
Checking in

Daniel Krutz <dxkvse@rit.edu>
To: "Piter Garcia (RIT Student)" <pzg8794@rit.edu>

Sun, Sep 14, 2025 at 7:35 AM

Sounds great. If you can give me a short 1-5 minute demo of the code you have running, then that would be great. Nothing super formal, just bring it up on your screen and share it.

Thanks
-Dan

On Sep 13, 2025, at 2:33 PM, Piter Garcia (RIT Student) <pzg8794@rit.edu> wrote:

Hi Dan,

Yes, Monday works.

Yes, I looked at the code and played with it all week. I built a framework to better understand their implementation, and make it easier to make changes or improvements.

Best,
Piter

On Sat, Sep 13, 2025 at 6:22AM Daniel Krutz <dxkvse@rit.edu> wrote:

Hi Piter, no problem as it's likely my fault for not confirming.

Would 10am Monday work for a zoom?

Your plan sounds good. Have you taken a look at the code that the University of Florida students have shared yet?

On Sep 12, 2025, at 3:57 PM, Piter Garcia (RIT Student) <pzg8794@rit.edu> wrote:

Hey Dan,

I am done with calls for today, the registration issue is carry on another week. Let me know if you will be able to meet today. If not, it is ok, we can meet on Monday air whenever you are available.

Again, I apologize for the confusion, to avoid this misunderstanding in the future I will follow up with an invite for our next meeting right after our meeting. That way we can have it on our calendars and reschedule or cancel as needed.

Best,
Piter

On Fri, Sep 12, 2025 at 3:19PM Piter Garcia (RIT Student) <pzg8794@rit.edu> wrote:

Hey Dan,

My apologies, I should have confirmed with you earlier if we were still meeting today. Instead, I assumed you were swamped with work since I never had a confirmation. Are you able to meet this evening? I just need to make some calls to figure out if an issue I have with registration was resolved, after that we can meet any time and I can walk you through the framework I have built to replicate their code implementation, and how I am modulating it to replace exp3. I reached out to Devroop to ask if I can get access to the iCMAB code to speed things up. Is that ok with you?

Best,
Piter

On Fri, Sep 12, 2025 at 9:25AM Daniel Krutz <dxkvse@rit.edu> wrote:

Did we have a call at 915 today?

On Sep 9, 2025, at 11:57 AM, Piter Garcia (RIT Student) <pzg8794@rit.edu> wrote:

Awesome, I will be working on the framework as intended in the meantime.

Best,
Piter

On Tue, Sep 9, 2025 at 6:58 AM Daniel Krutz <dxkvse@rit.edu> wrote:
Ok great, I sent Jie an email. Will see what he says.

Thanks
-Dan

On Sep 8, 2025, at 11:38 PM, Piter Garcia (RIT Student)
<pzg8794@rit.edu> wrote:

I think that's a great idea!

Getting access to Jie's source code would definitely speed things up on my end for a few reasons:

1. Reverse Engineering & Environment Setup: It would help me better understand their framework so I can reverse-engineer the logic and get our own version running, ideally in a more accessible environment where we can collaborate more easily and tell a cohesive story around the results.
2. Modularization & Experimentation: Having access to the original code would allow me to modularize components faster, enabling a "plug-and-play" structure where I can swap in different models or techniques and run comparative tests more systematically.
3. Baseline Integrity: Most importantly, when benchmarking our enhancements, we'd have confidence that we're testing against a faithful implementation of the original framework, not something we rebuilt from scratch. I think that gives more credibility to any improvements we demonstrate.

So yes, reaching out to Jie would be really helpful if he's open to sharing the code!

On Mon, Sep 8, 2025 at 8:07 PM Daniel Krutz <dxkvse@rit.edu> wrote:

Do you think it would be worth it if I reached out to Jie for the source code?

On Sep 8, 2025, at 3:04 PM, Piter Garcia (RIT Student) <pzg8794@rit.edu> wrote:

Hi Dan,

My apologies for the delayed response; I have been caught up all morning finishing what I hope are the last of my registration tasks, so I can fully shift my focus to research and school work.

As for your question (definitely not dumb at all!), I was actually planning to follow up with you about Jie's framework. I mentioned it briefly on Friday and wanted to confirm whether it's the right direction or if I should approach it differently.

To answer your question directly: I haven't found any public repositories or supplementary code linked to Jie's work so far. It doesn't appear to include any

standalone source code, but it does reference a few commonly used libraries and tools, such as:

- **PyTorch** – for training the RNN-based world and policy models
- **NetworkX** – likely for simulating graph-based environments
- **OpenAI Gym** – for environment structure and interaction loops
- **NumPy** – for numerical operations
- **EXAMM** – cited as the evolutionary method for generating forecasting RNNs
- **Matplotlib / Seaborn** – for visualizations
- **Ray / RLlib** – mentioned as potential alternatives for scalable RL but not directly used

I've started reviewing the framework more closely to see how I might replicate it using similar open-source models and examples. So far, I've found a few promising tools that could support implementation:

- **contextualbandits**: Lightweight library for prototyping contextual bandits
- **MABWiser**: Offers contextual and non-contextual bandit strategies with simulation support
- **ART (Adversarial Robustness Toolbox)**: Useful for modeling and testing adversarial threats
- A few comparative reviews and benchmarks of contextual bandit algorithms that could inform our evaluation

Let me know if you'd like me to continue exploring this route. And if Jie is available for a quick consultation or to share implementation insights/code, I'd be happy to reach out directly.

Best,
Piter

On Mon, Sep 8, 2025 at 11:10AM Daniel Krutz <dxkvse@rit.edu> wrote:

Hi Pieter, dumb question: Did Jie's work that I shared with you have any source code available, or did it just reference existing libraries that would need to be utilized?

Thanks
-Dan

> On Sep 4, 2025, at 8:10 PM, Piter Garcia (RIT Student) <pzg8794@rit.edu> wrote:

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> Sorry, I was in class and then I had to drive quickly to my next class.

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> Perfect, sounds good, I will use the link you sent for our meeting tomorrow.

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> Best,

> Piter